SAMPLE STATEMENT - FICTIONAL DATA FOR TRAINING ONLY - NOT A REAL ACCOUNT

BRENNAN & THALE ELDER LAW, PLLC

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A fictional law firm created for forensic accounting training

September 15, 2025

Forensic Accounting Team
Fraud Examination Practicum

Re: Evelyn R. Hartwell, conservatorship petition and civil recovery: engagement for forensic accounting services

Dear Team:

Thank you for agreeing to assist this office. We represent Laura Byrne, daughter and agent under power of attorney for her mother, Evelyn R. Hartwell, age 81, of Maple Grove, Iowa. Between April and May 2025 Mrs. Hartwell's checking account went from about $16,000, plus a $50,000 certificate of deposit, to overdrawn. Her paid caregiver, Dana M. Pruitt, who bills through DP Companion Care LLC, had access to her checkbook, debit card and online banking during that time.

Please answer the following, supported by workpapers:

1. What money left Mrs. Hartwell's accounts from March 1 through May 31, 2025, and where did it go? Trace it to the recipient accounts where the records allow.

2. How much of what was paid to DP Companion Care LLC and Ms. Pruitt is supported by the caregiver agreement and invoices (Exhibits C and D)? How much is not?

3. What happened to the cash withdrawn from Mrs. Hartwell's account?

4. Is the "family copy" of the April statement (Exhibit 5) a true copy? Is the Wrenfield Trust Bank statement (Exhibit 11) authentic, and does it support opposing counsel's claim that $24,000 was repaid?

5. What amount, in your opinion, left Mrs. Hartwell's control without documented authorization? Show the calculation and state what you could not determine.

Documents provided

Exhibit	Document	Source
1-4	Larkspur Valley Bank checking statements, March-May 2025, and the May 2025 Visa statement	Larkspur Valley Bank (authorization of Laura Byrne under power of attorney)
5	"Family copy" of the April 2025 checking statement	Emailed to Laura Byrne by Dana Pruitt, 06/24/2025
6	Scanned, redacted copy of the May 2025 checking statement	Maple Grove Police Department referral packet
7-8	DP Companion Care LLC business checking, April-May 2025	Quillbrook Credit Union, by subpoena
9-10	Dana M. Pruitt personal checking, April-May 2025	Oxbow Prairie National Bank, by subpoena
11	"Wrenfield Trust Bank" statement, May 2025	Enclosed with Exhibit I
A-I	This letter, interview notes, caregiver agreement, invoice, bank notices, wire confirmation, check images, opposing counsel's letter	Client file and Larkspur Valley Bank

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Please record the SHA-256 fingerprint of each statement file as you receive it, and keep your analysis to what the documents show: report findings as consistent or inconsistent with the explanations offered, and leave conclusions about intent or guilt to the trier of fact. If a record you need is missing, tell us what to request.

Your workpapers and a findings memo are due October 17, 2025.

Sincerely,

Ruth A. Brennan

Ruth A. Brennan, Attorney at Law